

Netflix: The top internet source

According to a study carried out by consultancy firm Sandvine, the largest single consumer of bandwidth of the internet in North America is Netflix

300ppi epaper display

E Ink and Epson have announced the co-development of a 9.7-inch high res 300ppi epaper display

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This is the sweet spot where you get the full HD resolution as well as good-looking monitors. The pricing of these monitors is unlikely to burn a hole in your pocket unless you go for speciality monitors like the Alienware Opt X AW2210.

AOC has beautifully designed monitors. Let's start off with AOC e2237Fw. It has a slim profile with the circuitry located in the lower half of the rear side; this is painted in glossy white plastic finish. The e2237Fw has a transparent bezel which extended all the way to the base. The monitor is kept in place with the help of a supporting thin stand on the rear side which allows minimal vertical swivel. A blue glow under the bezel helps in viewing the keyboard in the dark. The OSD functionality is activated by the touch sensor. The other AOC monitor, i.e. e2243Fwk is very similar to the e2043Fsk with a similar bulky base stand having VESA screws underneath.

BenQ 2200HD has a different form factor from the other monitors. For starters, the base stand is rectangular in shape and the base of the bezel diverges out from the panel. Buttons for the OSD menu are located on the right-hand side which are very comfortable to use.

Alienware OptX AW2210, although an old monitor, still had no competition in terms of looks, across all the categories. The sharp cuts, a mix of glossy and matte finishes, touch sensitive OSD controls, height adjustment are just some of the exciting features. We did notice the backlit touch controls not responding for a few seconds at times, but overall operation of the

BENQ M2700HD

This monitor was the largest one that we received. The M2700HD has a native resolution of 1080p which was somewhat disappointing as we were expecting something over and above it. This isn't your run-of-the-mill LCD monitor, but something much more. The M2700HD also complies with the BenQ tradition of well designed monitors. It has a glossy bezel with a textured finish on the rear side. There is a thin fibre-glass plate running through the panel which embeds the speaker section on the base of the bezel. It comes with a separate remote control for operating the monitor. There is a plethora of ports on this monitor. You have the standard DVI, two

HDMI, composite, component ports and two USB ports. The side panel also has two USB ports and an audio jack.

The contrast ratio on this monitor was not the best and we found the black level to be bad thanks to some prominent backlight bleeding. Movie viewing experience on the big screen is quite good if you excuse the not-so-good contrast in darker scenes. Skin tones and overall colour rendition did not have any issues. The sound emanating from the speaker section lacks a punch that is offered by a good set of 2.1's. It is great for casual listening or watching streaming videos, but for a great sound whilst watching movies, you will need external speakers. The remote control is quite responsive and is of great help as you no longer have to use the on monitor OSD buttons. Viewing angle for text was good, but not so much for movies and games. Text readability was quite good.

OSD menu is quite simple. There is a plethora of ports on the rear side comprising two HDMI ports, a DVI port, four USB ports and an audio jack. The stand is quite sturdy and has a great mechanism for height adjustment with good tilt mechanism.

Performance

AOC e2237Fw was impressive with its contrast ratio but faltered in the DisplayMate tests. The 16-ramp intensity test had a prominent greenish tinge on the blackest bands. Even the grey intensity tests had a green cast. In the 256-colour ramp test, banding was prominent in the cyan-to-blue transition. While viewing HD movies the greens looked a bit saturated but skin tones were quite good. There was some noise in the darker scenes and slight banding in solid scenes. Overall gaming



In BenQ E2200HD, the HD movie viewing was quite good in terms of colour rendition and skin tones, but it suffers from prominent backlight bleeding

experience was satisfactory with Resident Evil 5 and FarCry.

AOC e2243Fsk had the lowest contrast ratio among